

Whatever Happens, Happens For The Best

The Jewish **rabbi**, Akiba was travelling to a **distant** land, beyond a **desert**. One evening, he arrived at a small village, and decided to spend the night there. But to his **astonishment** and **dismay**, he found that the villagers were extremely **suspicious** of travellers. No one would give him **shelter**.

"It is hard to believe that any people can be so **inhospitable**, thought the rabbi . "But after all, God is **just**, and whatever happens, happens for the best.

He had only four **possessions** besides the clothes on his back: a book, a lamp, a cock that used to wake him at **dawn** with its **crowing**, and an ass on which he rode. On being refused shelter by the villagers, he went some distance ahead, and settled himself under a tree. He lit his lamp and opened his book so that he might read a few pages before going to sleep. He had read only a page when a **gust** of wind blew out the light. "What!" **exclaimed** the rabbi. "Am i not permitted even to read? But God is just, and whatever happens, happens for the best".

He **stretched** himself on the cold, **bare earth** to try to get a few hours' sleep. Just as he was **dozing off**, there was a cry of alarm from his cock followed by a loud flapping of wings. A wolf had caught the bird.

My faithful companion gone! thought the rabbi, and in such a **ghastly** manner.

But God is just and whatever happens, happens for the best.

Still later that night, a lion **pounced** on the ass and carried it away. Once again the rabbi told himself that whatever had happened, had happened for the best. After a sleepless night, he went back to the village to see if he could obtain a horse to carry him the rest of the way, but to his horror he found that all the houses had been **plundered** and their **inhabitants slaughtered** by robbers, during the night.

"Had these people not turned me away, I would have **perished** with them," thought the rabbi, and had the wind not blown out my light, the robbers would have detected my presence, and had wild beasts not carried away my animals, the noises they made would have **betrayed** my presence to those **marauders**, and I too would have lost my life. God is just, and whatever happens, happens for the best."



Vocabulary

1. **Rabbi** (noun) – priest, clergyman, preacher, spiritual leader, teacher – यहूदी पुजारी
2. **Distant** (adjective) – faraway, remote, far-off, secluded, outlying – दूरस्थ
3. **Desert** (noun) – wasteland, barren land, arid region, wilderness, sandy expanse – रेगिस्तान
4. **Astonishment** (noun) – amazement, surprise, wonder, awe, disbelief – आश्चर्य
5. **Dismay** (noun) – disappointment, distress, anxiety, consternation, disheartenment – निराशा
6. **Suspicious** (adjective) – doubtful, wary, distrustful, skeptical, apprehensive – संदेहपूर्ण
7. **Shelter** (noun) – refuge, protection, cover, haven, lodging – आश्रय
8. **Inhospitable** (adjective) – unfriendly, unwelcoming, cold, hostile, rude – अतिथि-अप्रिय
9. **Just** (adjective) – fair, righteous, impartial, ethical, lawful – न्यायप्रिय
10. **Possession** (noun) – belonging, asset, property, item, holding – संपत्ति
11. **Dawn** (noun) – daybreak, sunrise, first light, early morning, break of day – सुबह
12. **Crowing** (noun) – cock-a-doodle-doo, cry, call, squawk, chant – मुर्गे की बांग
13. **Exclaim** (verb) – cry out, shout, call, proclaim, blurt – चिल्लाना
14. **Stretch** (verb) – extend, spread, expand, reach out, elongate – फैलना
15. **Bare earth** (noun) – ground, soil, dirt, land, terrain – खुली ज़मीन
16. **Doze off** (phrasal verb) – nap, fall asleep, nod off, snooze, drift off – झपकी लेना
17. **Ghastly** (adverb) – horribly, dreadfully, gruesomely, terribly, frightfully – भयानक रूप से
18. **Pounce (on)** (verb) – leap, spring, jump, attack, lunge – झपटना
19. **Plunder** (verb) – loot, rob, pillage, ransack, raid – लूटना
20. **Inhabitant** (noun) – resident, dweller, citizen, occupant, native – निवासी
21. **Slaughter** (verb) – kill, massacre, butcher, execute, slay – हत्या करना
22. **Perish** (verb) – die, expire, pass away, succumb, be destroyed – मर जाना
23. **Betray** (verb) – reveal, expose, disclose, leak, unmask – धोखा देना / प्रकट कर देना

24. **Marauder** (noun) – looter, raider, bandit,

robber, pillager – लुटेरा

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